

SPA Ajibade & Co. Website: Guide for the Frontend Team

Live API: <https://spaaco.onrender.com/api/v1>

Full reference with sample responses: <https://spaaco.onrender.com/docs>

1. The big picture

Nearly all the text and pictures on the website come from our API. Nothing should be typed directly into the frontend code. The firm edits content in the admin dashboard, and the public website reads it from the API.

Your work comes down to three things:

- Fetch the content for a page.
- Show it.
- Send the three website forms back to us.

No API key or login is needed for the public website. Only the admin dashboard needs a login.

2. How responses look

Every successful response puts its content inside a **data** field. Lists also include a **meta** field with page information (current page, page size, total items, total pages).

Every error has the same shape: an **error** object with a **code** and a **message**. When a form is filled in wrongly, it also has a **details** list naming each field that needs fixing and why. You can show these messages next to the matching form fields.

Code	Meaning
200	Success
201	Form submitted and saved
400	Something in the request is wrong. Check details .
401	Not logged in, or the login has expired (admin only)
403	Logged in, but this account isn't allowed to do that
404	Not found, or not published yet
409	Someone else saved this item first (admin only)
428	The If-Match header is missing (admin only)
429	Too many requests. Wait a moment.

3. Building a page usually takes two requests

Request 1: the header and footer. **GET /site** returns everything that appears on every page. That includes the firm name, phone, email, social links, the menu and its dropdowns, the footer links, the office addresses, the newsletter text and the contact banner. Fetch it once, keep it, and reuse it on every page.

Request 2: the page itself. **GET /pages/{name}** returns one whole page with everything already put together. For example, **/pages/home** includes the hero slides, the video section, the awards band, the

featured practice areas, the leadership cards and the latest articles. You don't need to combine several requests.

The page names are: `home`, `about`, `practice-areas`, `people`, `insights`, `careers`, `faq`, `offices`, `recognition`, `responsible-business`.

Two page names work differently:

- `recognition` only holds the labels that every award page shares. Each award page itself comes from `/recognitions/{slug}`.
- `responsible-business` holds that page's title and slides. Its list of stories comes from `/insights?category=pro_bono`.

The hero at the top of every page is a slideshow. `images` is a list: three pictures on Home and one on the other pages. Only the picture changes between slides; the heading and buttons stay the same.

4. Lists, filters and paging

What	Request
Practice areas	GET /practice-areas
Attorneys	GET /people
Articles and news	GET /insights
Offices	GET /offices
FAQs	GET /faqs
Job openings	GET /jobs
Awards and directories	GET /recognitions

Paging. Add `?page=2` to get the second page. Add `?pageSize=` to change how many items come back. The default is 9 and the maximum is 50.

Attorney filters.

- `role` is one of: `managing_partner`, `partner`, `associate_partner`, `senior_associate`, `associate`, `trainee_associate`. Choosing `partner` also returns the Managing Partner, because the design has one "Partners" tab for both.
- `practiceArea` takes a practice area's slug. This is the "Sort By" dropdown in the design, and it combines with the role tab.
- `sort` is `seniority` (the default), `name_asc` or `name_desc`.
- `/pages/people` supplies the dropdown options.
- Each attorney card already includes the text for its back side, so flipping a card doesn't need another request.

Article filters.

- `category` is one of: `firm_news`, `articles`, `insights`, `regulatory_updates`, `news_updates`, `events`, `pro_bono`.
- `practiceArea` takes a practice area's slug.
- `sort` is `newest` (the default) or `oldest`.

- `/pages/insights` supplies the tabs and dropdown options.

Pro bono stories are kept separate. They appear only when you ask for `category=pro_bono`, and only on the Responsible Business page. They never show up in the main news feed, on Home, or in any other list.

5. Detail pages

Most detail pages are looked up by their slug, which is the web-address version of the title (for example `babatunde-ajibade`). Always build links from the slug in the list response, never from the title.

Page	Request
One practice area	GET <code>/practice-areas/{slug}</code>
One attorney	GET <code>/people/{slug}</code>
One article	GET <code>/insights/{slug}</code>
One award directory page	GET <code>/recognitions/{slug}</code>
Terms or Privacy Policy	GET <code>/legal/terms</code> or GET <code>/legal/privacy</code>
One job	GET <code>/jobs/{id}</code> (jobs use an id, not a slug)

- A practice area includes the practice lead's card, the list of all areas for the sidebar, and recent publications.
- An attorney includes their bio, education, contact links and recent publications.
- An article ends with a button (`cta`): "Read Article", "Watch Video", or nothing. `backLink` tells you where the "Back to..." link goes.

6. Search

GET `/search?q=arbitration`

- The search term must be 2 to 100 characters long.
- Results come back grouped into practice areas, attorneys and articles, with up to 5 in each group. It's built for a quick dropdown, not a full results page.
- Please wait until the user pauses typing before searching (debounce). The limit is 60 searches a minute per visitor.

7. The three forms

Form	Where it goes	Format
Discuss a Mandate	POST <code>/enquiries</code>	JSON
Contact / Send a message	POST <code>/messages</code>	JSON
Job application	POST <code>/jobs/{id}/applications</code>	File upload (multipart/form-data)

A successful submission returns code **201** and a reference number such as `ENQ-2026-0041`. Please show this number to the person; the firm will quote it back to them.

Mandate enquiry fields

- Required: `fullName` (2–120 characters), `email`, `summary` (at least 20 characters, at most 2000), `consent` (must be `true`), `consentTextVersion`, `turnstileToken`.
- Optional: `phone`, `organization`, `practiceArea` (a slug), `preferredOffice` (an office id), `website`.

Message fields

- The same as the enquiry, except it uses `message` (required, at least 10 characters) and `subject` (optional).
- It has no organization, practice area, office or summary fields.

Job application fields

- Required: `file` (the CV, PDF or Word .docx only, maximum 5 MB), `fullName`, `email`, `phone`, `consent`, `consentTextVersion`, `turnstileToken`.
- Optional: `coverNote` (up to 2000 characters), `website`.
- `consent` must be sent as the text "true", because file uploads can't send true/false values.
- The file field must be named exactly `file`.
- We check what the file really is, not just its name. A fake PDF will be rejected.

Three fields that need special care

- `consentTextVersion`: a short label for the exact consent wording shown next to the tick box, for example "v1-2026-01". The firm must be able to prove what wording people agreed to. Change the label whenever you change the wording, and never send it empty.
- `turnstileToken`: required even though the anti-spam check is currently switched off. For now, send any text, such as "disabled". When the firm switches Cloudflare Turnstile on, the real token goes here and nothing else in your code changes. Leaving it out causes an error.
- `website`: a trap for spam robots. Add it to the form as a hidden, empty field that people never see or fill in. Robots fill in every field. When this one arrives with something in it, we quietly discard the submission but still reply with a normal success. Keep it out of the browser's autofill.

Limit: 5 submissions per form, per visitor, every 10 minutes. If someone reaches the limit (code 429), show a friendly "please try again shortly" message.

8. Things that might surprise you

- **Some content is still missing.** A few items haven't come from the firm yet: the Home video link, the SEO titles and descriptions, LinkedIn links, some article summaries, and the "Why Choose Us" point descriptions. These come back as `null` (empty) or as an empty list. Please design proper empty states. It isn't a bug, and the content will appear on its own once the firm adds it.
- **Some text reads "[PENDING FROM FIRM]".** Currently this is two leadership card bios. Show it as it is; the firm will replace it.
- **Some buttons have no destination yet.** For example, "View Our Recognitions" on Home has no link (`href` is `null`). Show it however the design shows an inactive button.
- **Not every feature has a backend.** The newsletter signup and the chat assistant aren't built. The newsletter block comes with its text and `enabled: false`. Don't connect either to anything.
- **Drafts are invisible.** Anything the firm hasn't published doesn't appear in lists, and its page returns 404. Treat 404 as a normal "not found" page, not as a crash.

- **The first request can be slow.** The server is on a free plan and sleeps when nobody is using it. The first request after a quiet period can take up to about 30 seconds. After that it's fast. This goes away on a paid plan.
 - **Reading limit:** 300 requests a minute per visitor. Normal browsing won't hit it, but please don't poll repeatedly.
-

9. The admin dashboard

The dashboard is a private tool for four people at the firm, and a separate app from the public website.

Logging in

- There is no sign-up, no "forgot password" and no two-step login. Please don't build screens for these.
- Four accounts already exist, and they log in with a username (not an email) and a password:

Username	What they manage
admin	Everything
editor	All website content
hr	Jobs and job applications
business_dev	Enquiries and messages

- The login request is `POST /admin/auth/login` with `username` and `password`.
- If the login fails, show your own message, such as "Incorrect username or password". The API's own message still mentions "email", and we will fix that wording.

Staying logged in

- A successful login returns an access token that lasts about 15 minutes. It also sets a refresh cookie in the browser.
- Keep the access token in app memory only, not in `localStorage`.
- Send the token with every admin request as the header `Authorization: Bearer <token>`.
- When a request returns 401, call `POST /admin/auth/refresh` with credentials included. You get a new token, then retry the request.
- Each refresh cookie works only once. If the same one is used twice, we assume it was stolen and log that account out everywhere. So make sure two refreshes never run at the same time.
- Log out with `POST /admin/auth/logout`.

Profile and password

- Each person can set their name and a notification email with `PATCH /admin/auth/me`. This email is where new enquiries, messages or applications are sent; it isn't used to log in.
- Change a password with `PATCH /admin/auth/password`.

Who can do what

Hide the parts of the dashboard a person can't use. The API refuses them anyway, but a button that always says "not allowed" is frustrating.

Area	admin	editor	hr	business_dev
Website content, pages, settings, legal pages, media	Yes	Yes	Jobs only	No
Enquiries and messages	Yes	No	No	Yes
Job applications and CVs	Yes	No	Yes	No
User accounts, activity log	Yes	No	No	No

Editing content

Nine kinds of content all work the same way, so one editor screen can serve all of them. They are: practice areas, people, insights, offices, recognition directories, awards, industries, FAQs and jobs.

Action	Request
List items	GET /admin/content/{type} (add ?status=draft or ?status=published to filter, ?q= to search)
Create an item	POST /admin/content/{type}
Open one item	GET /admin/content/{type}/{id}
Save changes	PATCH /admin/content/{type}/{id}
Delete	DELETE /admin/content/{type}/{id}
Make it public	POST /admin/content/{type}/{id}/publish
Take it down	POST /admin/content/{type}/{id}/unpublish
Change the order	PATCH /admin/content/{type}/reorder

Two rules when saving

- **Send back the revision number.** Every item has a **revision** number. When saving, send it back in the header **If-Match: <revision>**. Without the header you get 428 and nothing is saved. If someone else saved in the meantime, you get 409. In that case, tell the user "someone else changed this", reload the item, and let them redo their change. This stops people overwriting each other's work.
- **What you load is what you save.** The item you load is already in the exact shape the save request expects. Load it into the form and send it back; no reshaping needed.

Publishing. New items start as drafts and stay invisible on the website until someone presses Publish. Making this review step easy is the main job of the dashboard.

Other dashboard sections

Section	Request
Site settings (phone, email, socials, menus, footer)	/admin/settings
Page text for the ten pages	/admin/pages/{name}
Terms and Privacy Policy	/admin/legal/{terms or privacy}
Media library (images and PDFs)	/admin/media
Enquiries inbox	/admin/enquiries
Messages inbox	/admin/messages
Job applications inbox	/admin/applications
Activity log (who changed what)	/admin/audit-logs
User accounts	/admin/users

Settings, pages and legal pages also need the **If-Match** header. A legal page is published or withdrawn by setting its **status** field when you save it.

Media library

- Images: need an alt description. Maximum size is 10 MB.
- PDFs: upload with **kind=document** and a title, which becomes the link text. Maximum size is 20 MB.
- Filtering: use **?kind=image** or **?kind=document**.
- Wrong type: putting a PDF where an image belongs, or the other way round, is refused.

CVs are protected

CVs contain personal data protected by Nigerian law, so they never have a public link.

- When an HR user clicks to view one, request **GET /admin/applications/{id}/cv**.
- You get a link that works for only 5 minutes. Open it straight away, and never save or share it.
- Every time a link is issued, it's recorded in the activity log.

10. Before launch

- **Tell us your final website addresses.** Right now the API accepts requests from any website. Once we know your domains, we'll restrict it to only those.
- **Automatic updates are available.** If your site rebuilds pages on a schedule, we can notify it automatically whenever content changes. Just ask.

11. Questions

If a field you need is missing, or a response doesn't fit the design, please tell us rather than working around it. Changing the API now is quick; changing it after launch is much harder.